

CLAIRE — Technique Candidates

Run date: 2026-05-24

Cross-platform workflow techniques surfaced this cycle. Test manually before considering any configuration change.

1. Plan-Before-Execute Prompting [HIGH]

Before asking the AI to produce output, instruct it to first list the criteria or components the output needs to satisfy, then generate the output. For example: 'Before writing, list the 4 things this email needs to do well. Then write it.' This forces the model to establish an evaluation framework before drafting, resulting in more structured and purposeful responses.

Source signal: [/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#), [/r/VAClaims/comments/1tk082g/steal_my_claude_prompt/](#), <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=44549209>

Test: On your next writing or analysis task, prepend 'Before doing this, list [N] things the output needs to accomplish. Then proceed.' and compare the result to a direct prompt.

2. Examples Over Adjectives [HIGH]

Instead of describing desired tone or style with adjectives (e.g., 'professional but friendly'), paste concrete examples of text that embody the target quality. The AI infers style from the examples rather than interpreting vague descriptors, producing output that more closely matches the actual intent.

Source signal: [/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#), [/r/VAClaims/comments/1tk082g/steal_my_claude_prompt/](#), <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=44549209>

Test: Replace adjective-based style instructions in your next prompt with one or two pasted example sentences or paragraphs that demonstrate the tone you want.

3. Pre-Task Requirements Elicitation [HIGH]

Before asking the AI to perform a task, first ask it what information or context it would need to do the task well. This surfaces gaps in your prompt that you can fill before the AI attempts the work, reducing back-and-forth and improving first-draft quality. Phrased as: 'Before I ask you to do X, what would you need to see first?'

Source signal: [/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#), [/r/VAClaims/comments/1tk082g/steal_my_claude_prompt/](#), <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=44549209>

Test: At the start of a complex request, ask 'What information would you need from me to do this well?' before providing your full prompt, then supply what it asks for.

4. Explicit Anti-Hallucination Instruction [HIGH]

Include a direct instruction in the prompt telling the AI not to invent information, assume facts not provided, or fill gaps with plausible-sounding but unverified content. Variants include: 'Do not assume anything and always ask for clarification' or 'If you don't know, say so rather than guessing.' This is especially effective in high-stakes or domain-specific tasks like legal, medical, or benefits claims contexts.

Source signal: [/r/VAClaims/comments/1tk082g/steal_my_claude_prompt/](#),
[/r/ClaudeAI/comments/1tg52af/5_claude_patterns_that_helped_nontechnical_users/](#),
<https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=44549209>

Test: Add the phrase 'Do not invent or assume any information not explicitly provided — ask me if something is unclear' to the system prompt or beginning of your next high-stakes query.

Total technique candidates this cycle: 4